

Basic Sources of Shariah



Al- Quran Al Kareem

القرآن الكريم

Objectives of the Topic



- ❧ Establishing that the Quran is the word of Allah, not of any Prophet, angel, or jinn.
- ❧ Introducing the sciences of the Quran, including its revelation, compilation, Makki-Madani verses, and abrogation.
- ❧ Teaching students to understand, reflect, and contemplate on the Quran.
- ❧ Preventing errors in learning and teaching due to ignorance of Quranic sciences.
- ❧ Understanding the efforts of the Prophet ﷺ, his companions, and scholars in preserving the Quran.

WHAT IS THE MEANING OF WORD 'QURAN' ?

- **Linguistically, the word 'Qur'an'** comes from the word al-qar, which means "gathering" and "putting things together (the news and commands stated by Allah *سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَى*) or that which has been compiled and preserved (i.e., in written manuscripts and in hearts).
- **Alternatively:** That which is frequently read and recited extensively.
- **Complete Definition:** It is the speech of Allah, not created, revealed to Prophet Muhammad *صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ* through clear revelation in pure Arabic. It is recited as an act of worship, preserved through continuous transmission (*Tawatur*), written in the *Mushaf*, and begins with Surah Al-Fatiha and ends with Surah An-Nas.

OTHER NAMES OF THE QUR'AN

- The revelation from Allah to the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ is referred to in the Qur'an itself by the name Qur'an (recitation) as well as by other names, such as e.g.
- Al Quraan (43 times).
- Al Furqaan (The Criterion) (6 times).
- Al Dhikr (The Reminder) (268 times).
- Al Kitaab (319 times).
- Some scholars have identified more than ninety names of the Qur'an, while additional references describe it with attributes such as Nur (Light), Huda (Guidance), Rahma (Mercy), Majeed (Glorious), Mubarak (Blessed), Basheer (Announcer), Nadheer (Warner), and Tanzeel (Revelation), each highlighting a unique aspect of its divine essence.
- The multiplicity of names and abundance of attributes for something indicates its honor and virtue.

The Revelation of the Quran (Duration and Manner)

The following are the three stages of the Quran's revelation:

1. The First Revelation: In the Preserved Tablet (Lawh al-Mahfuz)

As Allah Almighty said: " Indeed, it is a glorious Quran, [recorded] in a Preserved Tablet." (Al-Buruj: 21-22).

2. The Second Revelation: From the Preserved Tablet to Bayt al-'Izzah (the House of Honor).

As Allah Almighty said:" We revealed it on a blessed night, for indeed We were to warn [mankind]. (Ad-Dukhan: 3)

Also: " Indeed, We sent it down during the Night of Decree." (Al-Qadr: 1)

The Revelation of the Quran (Duration and Manner)

3. The Third Revelation: From Bayt al-'Izzah to the heart of the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ), gradually, as per the condition.

Allah Almighty said:

"And [it is] a Quran which We have divided [into parts] so that you may recite it to people at intervals, and We have revealed it gradually." (Al-Isra: 106).

Summary: The Quran was revealed over approximately 23 years, beginning with Surah Al-'Alaq and concluding with Surah An-Nasr. The final verse revealed was: "Fear a Day when you will be returned to Allah" (Al baqarah: 281) following the verse about interest (Riba). The Quran was gradually revealed during various times and places in the Prophet's (ﷺ) life.

How the Holy Quran was preserved?



- The Qur'an was preserved through both mass memorization and written recording. Though scribes wrote down its verses, the predominantly unlettered Muslim community relied on oral transmission from the Prophet ﷺ
- During the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime, Qur'anic verses were written on various materials but not compiled into a single text, as revelation was ongoing, with verses being added and abrogated.
- The written preservation of the Qur'an occurred in stages. After many Huffaz were martyred in the Battle of Yamama (11 AH/632 CE), Hazrat Umar advised Hazrat Abu Bakr to compile it into one volume. The task was entrusted to Hazrat Zaid bin Thabit and later standardized under Hazrat Uthman.
- The Qur'an was originally written on materials such as parchment (riqq), leather, palm stalks, shoulder blades of animals, and white stones. These were commonly used writing surfaces in early Arabia.

Distinguishing Features of the Quran

- ❑ Preservation of the Quran, so it remains unchanged among all heavenly books to this day.
- ❑ Memorization and writing during the life of the Prophet Muhammad (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ).
- ❑ Protection in the language of revelation until the Day of Judgment, memorized by millions, and its chain of transmission (Tawatur) is established through numerous reciters (10 Qira'at=dialects).
- ❑ It is recited continuously across the world and has been translated into every well-known language. Reciting and listening to it are among the best acts of worship. Whoever recites a letter from it will receive ten rewards for each letter.

Distinguishing Features of the Quran

- ❖ The Qur'an aligns with human nature, offering complete guidance on beliefs, worship, ethics, and all aspects of life. It provides answers to every question related to righteousness and governance.
- ❖ Complete eloquence and rhetoric, and a miracle.
- ❖ It heals hearts from spiritual diseases like polytheism and hypocrisy and offers physical healing through verses like Surah Al-Fatiha and Al-Mu'awwidhat. It brings tranquility and certainty, comforting those facing worry, sadness, or illness.
- ❖ The Noble Quran informs about future events that can only be known through divine revelation.

The Main Themes of the Quran

- **The Quran covers the following five main themes:**
 1. **Tawheed (Oneness of Allah) and His Blessings.**
 2. **Stories of past Prophets and their nations.**
 3. **Akhirah (Death, Resurrection, and Afterlife).**
 4. **Ahkam (Laws and Commands of Shariah).**
 5. **Refutation of False Beliefs and Arguments.**

Quran and Science

Scientific Concepts (A brief overview of key scientific terms)

1. **Hypothesis:** A possible explanation or prediction that can be tested.

Example: If plants receive more sunlight, they will grow taller.

2. **Scientific Fact:** Something observed and repeatedly confirmed as true.

Example: The Earth orbits the Sun, OR Water boils at 100°C at sea level.

3. **Scientific Theory:** A well-supported explanation of facts based on evidence.

Example: Charles Darwin's theory of evolution by natural selection.

4. **Scientific Law:** A statement describing a consistent natural phenomenon, often in mathematical form.

Example: Newton's Law of Gravity states that objects attract each other based on their mass.



FINGERPRINTS

أَلَيْسَبُ الْإِنْسَانُ أَلَّنْ نَجْمَعُ عِظَامَهُ

بَلَىٰ قَدَرِينَا عَلَىٰ أَنْ نُسَوِّيَ بَنَانَهُ

**DOES MAN THINK THAT WE CANNOT ASSEMBLE HIS BONES?
NAY, WE ARE ABLE TO PUT
TOGETHER IN PERFECT ORDER THE
VERY TIPS OF HIS FINGERS.**

Quran: Surah Al-Qiyamah 75:3-4

Why does the Qur'an, while speaking about determination of the identity of the individual, speak specifically about fingertips? In 1880, fingerprinting became the scientific method of identification, after research done by Sir Francis Colt. No two persons in the world can ever have exactly the same fingerprint pattern, not even identical twins.

Fourteen Hundred Years ago, who could have known the uniqueness of each Human's Fingerprint? Surely It could have been none other than the Creator Himself!





IRON

Iron is not natural to the Earth. It did not form on the Earth but came down to Earth from outer space. This may sound strange but it's true.

Scientists have found that billions of years ago the Earth was struck by meteorites. These meteorites were carrying iron from distant stars which had exploded.



وَأَنْزَلْنَا الْحَدِيدَ فِيهِ
بَأْسٌ شَدِيدٌ وَمَنْفَعٌ لِلنَّاسِ

The Quran says the following on the origin of Iron:

**WE SENT DOWN IRON WITH ITS GREAT
INHERENT STRENGTH AND ITS MANY
BENEFITS FOR HUMANKIND.**

Quran: Surah Al-Hadid 57:25

Allah uses the words 'sent down' for iron. It is clear from the verse that iron is not an Earthly material, but was sent down for the benefit of humanity. The fact that iron came down to Earth from outer space is something which could not be known by the primitive science of the 7th century.



MOUNTAINS

The Quran draws our attention to a very important characteristic of mountains:

**"DID WE NOT MAKE THE EARTH
A RESTING PLACE?
AND THE MOUNTAINS AS STAKES"**

Quran: Surah An-Naba 78:6-7

أَلَمْ نَجْعَلِ الْأَرْضَ مَهْدًا
وَالْجِبَالَ أَوْتَادًا



The Quran indicates that mountains have deep roots by using the word stakes to describe them. In fact, mountains do have deep roots, and the word 'stakes' is an accurate description for them. Mount Everest (pictured above), the height of which is approximately 9km above ground, has a root deeper than 125km.

The fact that mountains have deep stake-like roots was not known until after the development of the theory of plate tectonics in the beginning of the 20th Century.



EXPANSION OF THE UNIVERSE

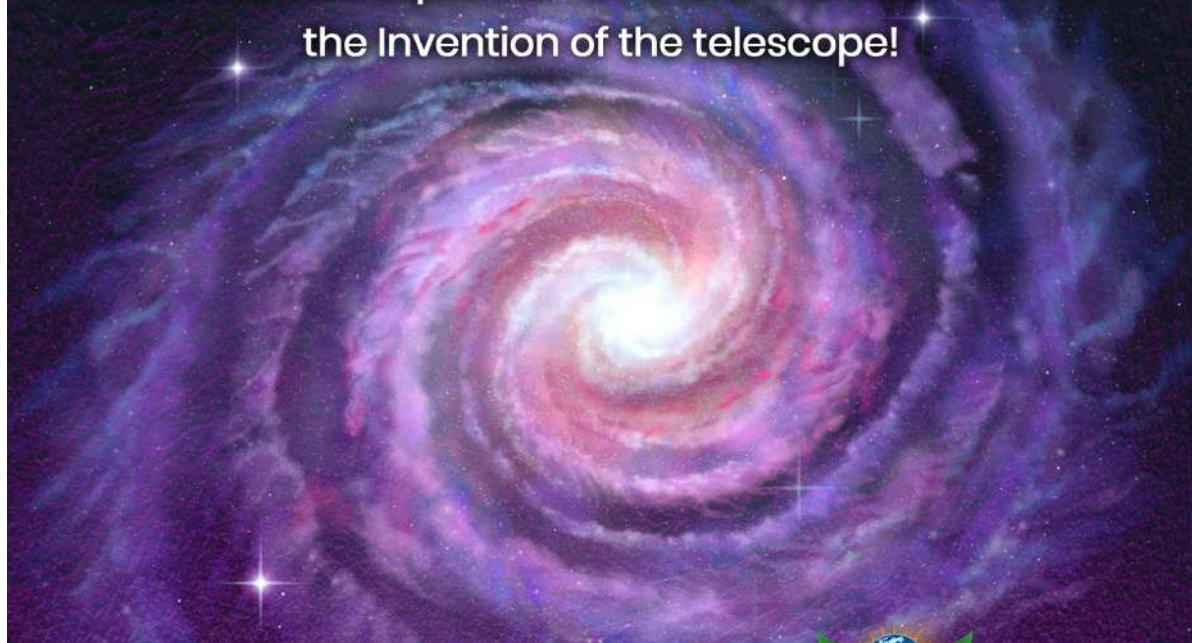
At a time when the science of astronomy was still Primitive,
The expansion of the universe was described in the Quran:

وَالسَّمَاءَ بَنَيْنَاهَا بِأَيْدٍ وَإِنَّا لَمُوسِعُونَ

**AND IT IS WE WHO HAVE BUILT THE
UNIVERSE WITH [OUR CREATIVE]
POWER AND KEEP EXPANDING IT.**

Quran: Surah Al-Dhāriyāt 51:47

The fact that the universe is expanding was discovered in the last century. The physicist Stephen Hawking in his book 'A Brief History of Time' wrote, 'The discovery that the universe is expanding was one of the great intellectual revolutions of the 20th Century. The Quran mentioned the expansion of the universe even before the Invention of the telescope!'





OCEANOLOGY

SALT & SWEET WATER BARRIER

Consider the following Qur'anic verse in this regard:

مَرَجَ الْخَازِنَتَيْنِ
بَيْنَهُمَا بَرْزَخٌ لَّا يَبْغِيَانِ

**HE HAS LET FREE THE TWO BODIES OF FLOWING
WATER, MEETING TOGETHER; BETWEEN THEM IS
A BARRIER WHICH THEY DO NOT TRANSGRESS.**

Quran: Surah Ar-Rahman 55:19-20

FRESH WATER

SEA WATER





THE SUN ROTATION

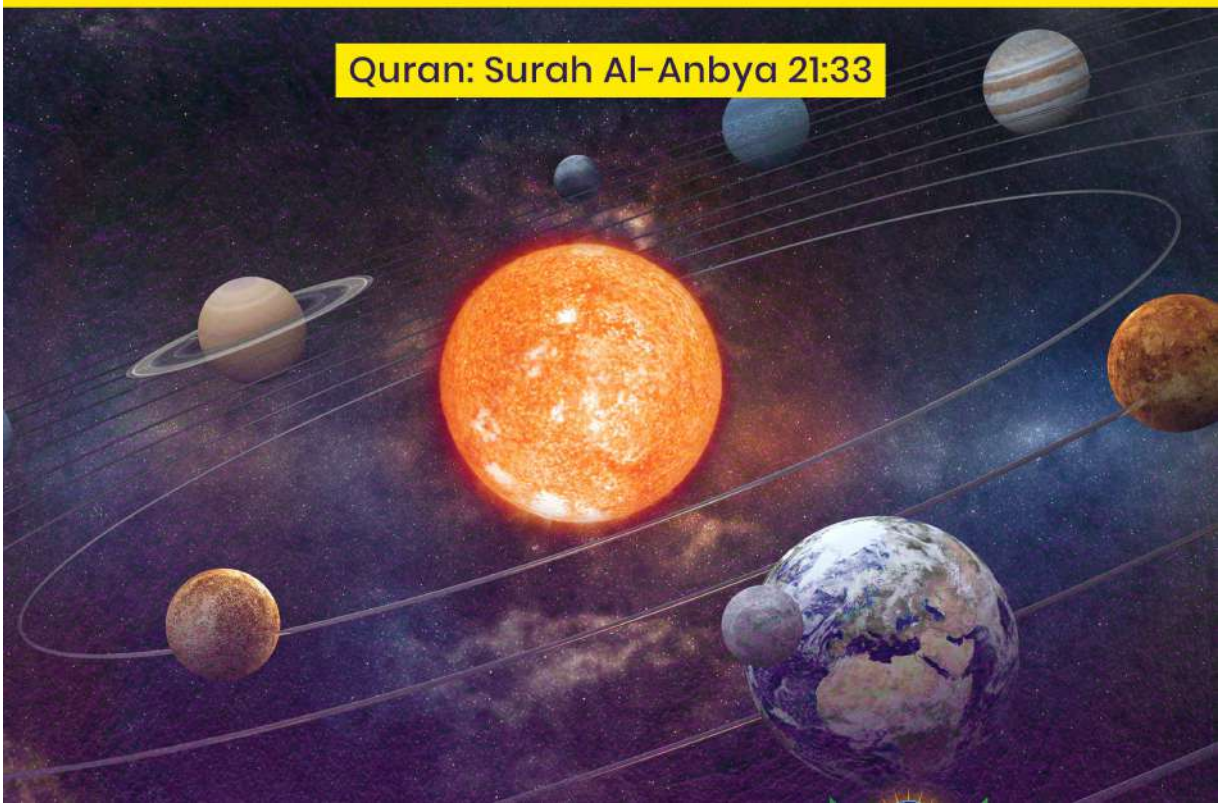
Consider the following Qur'anic verse regarding the sun rotation:

وَهُوَ الَّذِي خَلَقَ اللَّيْلَ وَالنَّهَارَ وَالشَّمْسَ
وَالْقَمَرَ كُلٌّ فِي فَلَكٍ يَسْبَحُونَ

"IT IS HE WHO CREATED THE NIGHT AND THE DAY, AND THE SUN AND THE MOON:

**ALL (THE CELESTIAL BODIES)
SWIM ALONG, EACH IN ITS
ROUNDED COURSE"**

Quran: Surah Al-Anbya 21:33



The Bible, The Qur'an and Science



Maurice Bucaille

Al-Islam.org